Management

Non Medical: Abdominal binder

Surgical management:

- Herniorrhaphy
- Hernioplasty

Nursing management

- Provide trendelenburg's position
- Administer stool softners



Inguinal hernias are the most common type of hernia

Prevention

- Stop smoking
- Avoid developing a persistent cough
- Maintain appropriate body weight for the age.
- Avoid straining during bowel movements
- Lift objects with knee flexion and not with hip flexion.
- Heavy lifting should be avoided for 4 to 6 weeks after treatment.

Complication

- **Strangulation**: reduced blood supply to a herniated organ.
- **Obstruction**: the bowel contents may no longer be able to pass through the herniated area, leading to cramps, the absence of defecation and vomiting.
- Recurrence hernia

2.14 Haemorrhoids (Piles)

Haemorrhoids, also known as piles are swelling containing enlarged blood vessels found inside or around the rectum and anus.

Definition

An abnormal mass of dilated and engorged blood vessels either internally in the anal canal or externally around the anus

Causes

- Straining during bowel movements
- Sitting for long periods of time on the toilet
- Chronic diarrhoea or constipation
- Obesity
- Pregnancy

Types

- **Internal haemorrhoids** - inside the rectum.
- **External haemorrhoids** - around the anus.

Symptoms

- Painless bleeding during bowel movements
- Itching or irritation in anal region
- Pain or discomfort
- Swelling around the anus

Diagnosis

- **Digital rectal examination** - to detect the unusual growths.
- **Inspection** - examine the lower portion of the colon and rectum with proctoscope
- **Colonoscopy** to examine the entire colon

Management

- Home remedies
- Eat high-fibre foods (fruits, vegetables and whole grains.)
- Increase fluid intake
- Use topical ointment
- Sitz bath for 10 to 15 minutes, two to three times a day.
- Keep the anal area clean.
- Apply ice packs or cold compresses on anus to relieve swelling and pain

Medical management

- Lidocaine that can relieve pain and itching

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